

has 0.6 hospital beds per 1,000 people, far below the WHO recommendation of 3.5 per 1,000. Additionally, there is just one government doctor per 10,189 people, against the WHO norm of 1:1,000, and 1.7 nurses per 1,000 people, compared to the recommended three per 1,000. Primary healthcare facilities such as sub-centres (SCs), primary health centres (PHCs) and community health centres (CHCs) are insufficient to meet the needs of India's vast population. As of March 2023, India had 150,488 SCs, 31,859 PHCs, and 6,064 CHCs, but these often operate with severe staff shortages, says the PRS Legislative Research report. More than 70% CHCs lack essential specialists such as surgeons, paediatricians and physicians. The doctor-patient ratio is particularly poor in rural areas, where a single PHC serves over 35,000 people, exceeding the recommended 30,000 for plains and 20,000 for hilly regions.

"A strong public-private partnership (PPP) model, powered by data-driven insights, can help tailor healthcare solutions at the district level, ensuring access to quality diagnostics, skilled healthcare professionals, essential medicines and specialised care where they are needed most," says Anand K., Managing Director & CEO, Agilus Diagnostics Ltd.

In India, nearly 55% hospitalisations occur in private facilities and out-of-pocket expenditure accounts for 48% health spending, far higher than the global average of 18%. Although the Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY) provides ₹5 lakh coverage per family annually, its funding—₹7,300 crore for FY25—raises concerns about sustainability. Moreover, the PM-JAY primarily covers hospitalisations, and outpatient services and diagnostics, a large part of



"Expanding insurance coverage and embedding diagnostic services into initiatives like Ayushman Bharat will enhance accessibility and affordability"

Ameera Shah

PROMOTER, METROPOLIS HEALTHCARE

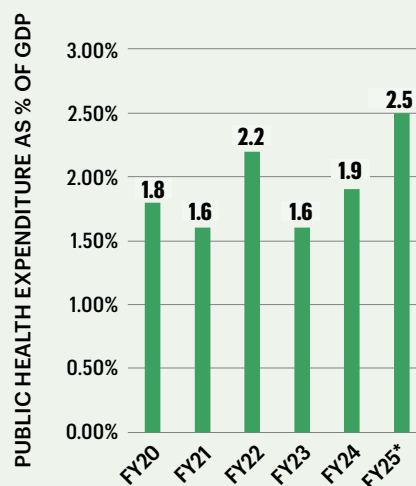
healthcare expenses, are uncovered, pushing many into financial distress.

"The government has launched key initiatives to strengthen healthcare, including Ayushman Bharat Health and Wellness Centres and the PM Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission. However, there is a significant reliance on the private sector," says Arup Mitra, Professor of Economics at South Asian University in New Delhi.

The shortage of medical professionals is another pressing concern. India requires 2.4 million more doctors and 3.3 million nurses to meet global standards. Despite producing one lakh doctors and 250,000 nurses annually, uneven distribution worsens the crisis, especially in rural states like Bihar and Uttar Pradesh, where the doctor-patient ratio is even worse at one per 28,000 people. The private sector employs 80% doctors, further limiting the acces-

LOW ON PRIORITY

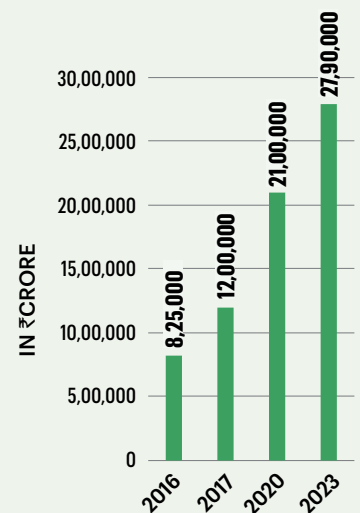
- Central spending on health yet to touch 2% of GDP



*ESTIMATES SOURCE PIB

THE EXPANDING PIE

- Fast growth of healthcare sector shows massive demand



SOURCE FROST & SULLIVAN, LSI FINANCIAL SERVICES, DELOITTE